

LOOKING BEYOND

- 01 Under Sandeep Kalra, Persistent has achieved 19 straight quarters of revenue growth
- 02 The company is shifting from a traditional IT services model to an AI-first approach
- 03 It has made several acquisitions in the last five years to strengthen expertise in cloud security, data privacy, and AI
- 04 Its deep technical expertise, agility, and proactive client solutions give it an edge
- 05 Kalra sees India as a global AI leader if it moves from services to tech development



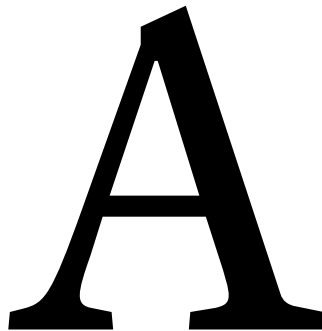
BEST CEOs

SANDEEP KALRA
TECH TITAN—JOINT WINNER

PERSISTENT CHALLENGER

Sandeep Kalra is redefining the IT services landscape with an AI-led, platform-driven approach

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**



ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) is reshaping businesses by automating processes, enhancing decision making, and improving customer experiences across sectors such as healthcare, manufacturing, and finance. Recently, China challenged the US' domination of the AI space. While both countries have made significant progress in AI, India, with its burgeoning tech talent and digital transforma-

tion ambitions, is working overtime to catch up.

At the forefront of India's digital transformation is Pune-based IT services company Persistent Systems. Sandeep Kalra, CEO of Persistent Systems, was recognised as the joint winner in the **Tech Titan** category in *BT-PwC India's Best CEOs 2025* study. Kalra is reshaping Persistent Systems into a powerhouse of AI-led, platform-driven services.

Persistent Systems primarily operates in three sectors: technology, healthcare and life sciences, and banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI). Technology, which includes partnerships with major independent software vendors like Microsoft, Google, and Amazon, accounts for 45% business. BFSI contributes 30%, while healthcare and life sciences—covering scientific instruments, medical devices, diag-